

Son of Sam

Raneem Sayyad
6/27/1977

CRIM 545: Sayyad

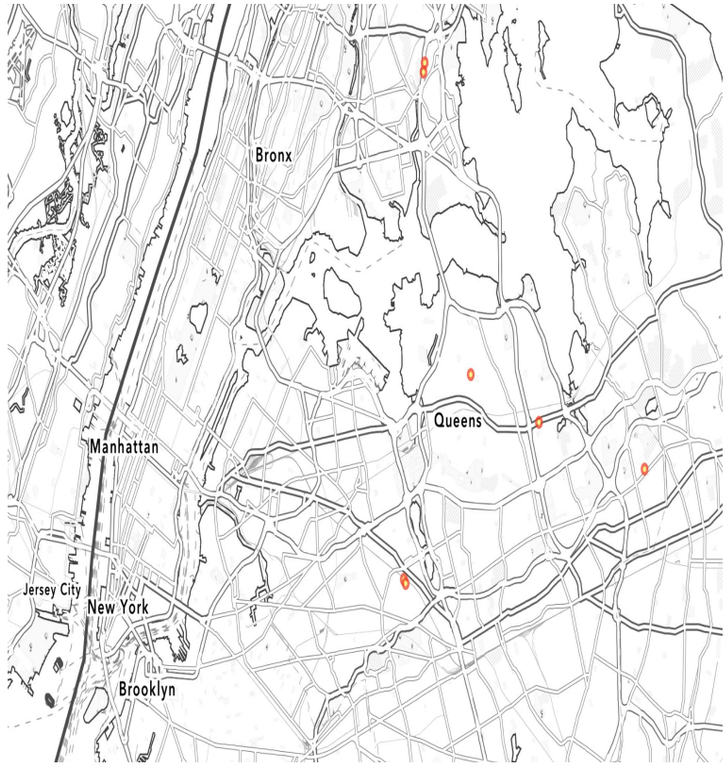
Executive Summary

- Serial killer targeting 13 victims since last year in New York City.
- The next event is likely to involve a female with dark long hair, possibly accompanied by a male, on a weekend night between midnight and 3 a.m. between July 30, 1977 and September 10, 1977, most likely around Forest Hills Gardens or near North New Hyde Park, particularly near Glen Oaks Shopping Center, 260th Street, 75th Avenue, and Burns Street, with interventions focusing on interception, deterrence, and community outreach.

Area Orientation

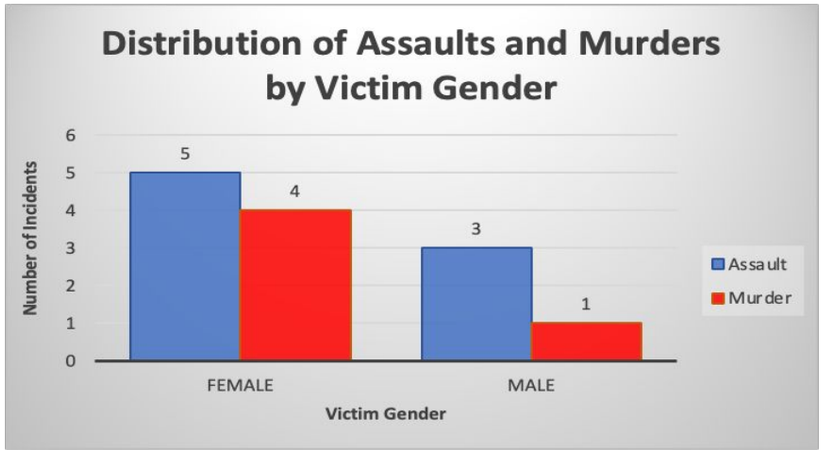






Behavioral Analysis

- Crime Activity
  - Total Events: 7 (1976-1977)
  - Murders: 5
  - Non-fatal assaults: 8
  - Total Victims: 13
  - Offenses committed using firearms
  - Crimes occurred in public and semi-private locations

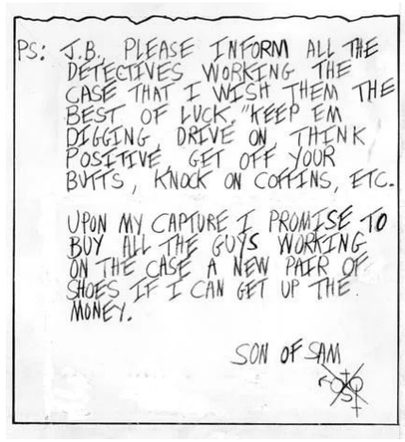


- Victims Description
  - Female Victims: late teens to mid-20s, majority of victims, often long dark hair
  - Male Victims: primarily non-fatal assaults
  - Male victims typically around age 20 (one aged 30)

The archetypal event in this series involves a lone white male offender approaching a parked vehicle at night in an isolated or semi-private location. The offender uses a firearm to attack a young female victim, typically in her late teens to mid-20s with long dark hair. Male companions, if present, may be assaulted but usually survive. The attack is quick, and the offender immediately flees the scene.

Behavioral Analysis

- Suspect Description
  - White male
  - Estimated age: mid-20s to 30s
  - Operates alone
  - Vehicle: cream-colored (or yellow) 1970 Ford Galaxy
- Modus Operandi (M.O.)
  - Strikes at night
  - Targets isolated or semi-private locations
  - Approaches parked vehicles
  - Attacks victims seated inside vehicles
  - Uses a firearm (.44 Special caliber Bulldog revolver)
  - Fires weapon and immediately flees the scene

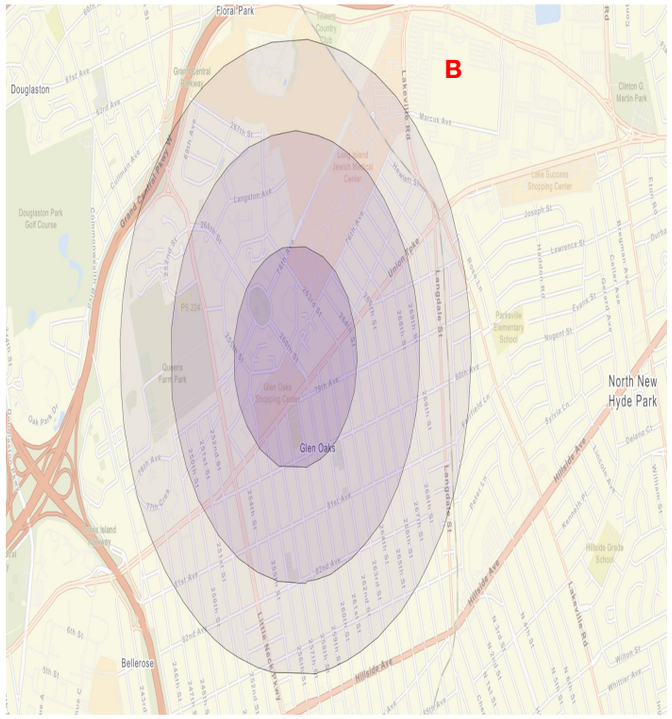


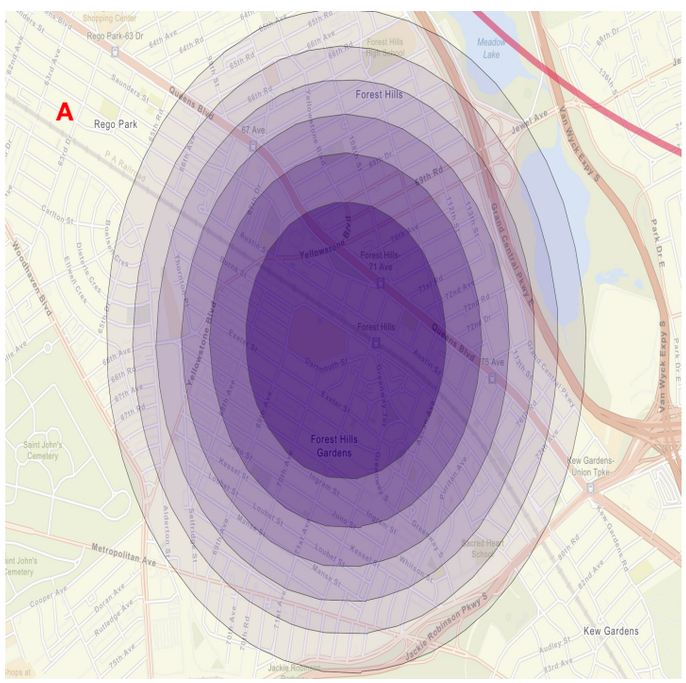




The next event is expected to occur during weekend nighttime hours and will most likely involve a firearm assault against a young female in her late teens to early twenties with long dark hair in a secluded or semi-private location, such as a parked vehicle, with any accompanying male at increased risk of a non-fatal assault.

Spatial Analysis

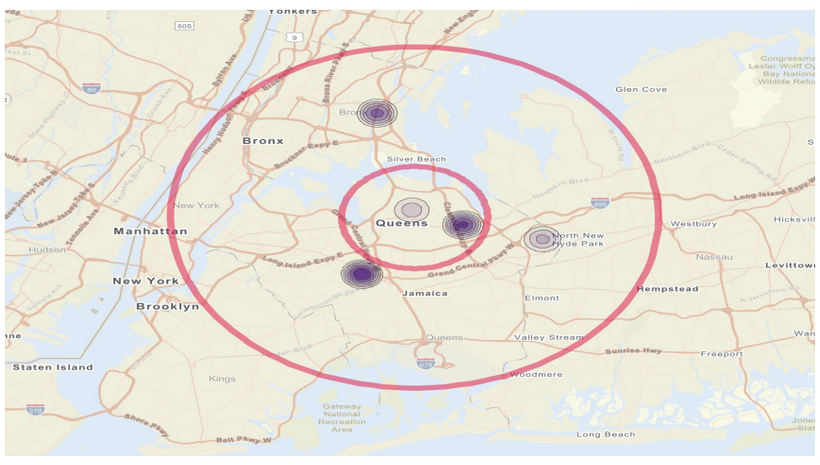




- Significant Findings
  - Center: Mean center: St. Andrew Avellino Catholic Academy (157th St, 158th St, 35th Ave, Northern Blvd)
  - Movement Pattern / Sequence: Forest Hills → North New Hyde Park → Bayside → Central Queens → Pelham Bay
  - Once an area is left - offender rarely returns
  - Repeat Locations: Only Forest Hills Garden had consecutive events; all others single events
  - Expansion: Offender gradually moves outward across boroughs (Queens → Bronx → toward Brooklyn/Jamaica)
- Commonalities
  - Location Types: Low-traffic streets, residential blocks, semi-public areas, and parking lots
  - Pattern: Mostly new neighborhoods each event; repeat use rare
  - Corridors: Clusters form predictable paths across neighborhoods

Spatial Analysis



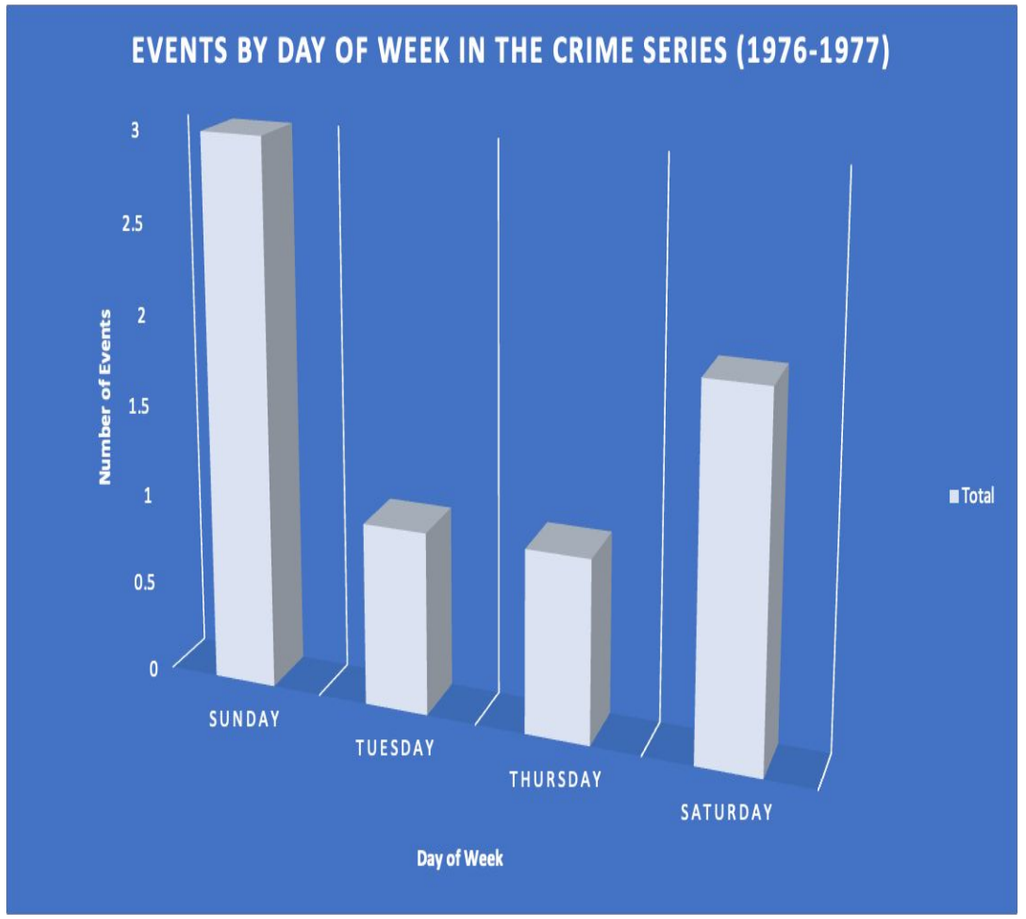


- Macro-Level
  - Queens and Bronx, New York City, NY
  - Series spans multiple neighborhoods - offender expanding across boroughs
  - Covers residential and semi-public areas
  - Geographic reach extends toward Brooklyn and Jamaica
- Micro-Level
  - 7 events that cluster into 5 distinct areas
  - Forest Hills Garden - singular consecutive attack
  - North New Hyde Park - single event
  - Bayside - single event
  - Central Queens - single event
  - Pelham Bay - single event

The next event is likely in Forest Hills Gardens or near North New Hyde Park, with specific areas to monitor including Glen Oaks Shopping Center, 260th Street, 75th Avenue, Burns Street, highway service roads, local streets, and parking areas near homes and apartments. The offender usually targets new neighborhoods but may revisit areas they have struck before or locations along major roadways within these neighborhoods.

Temporal Analysis

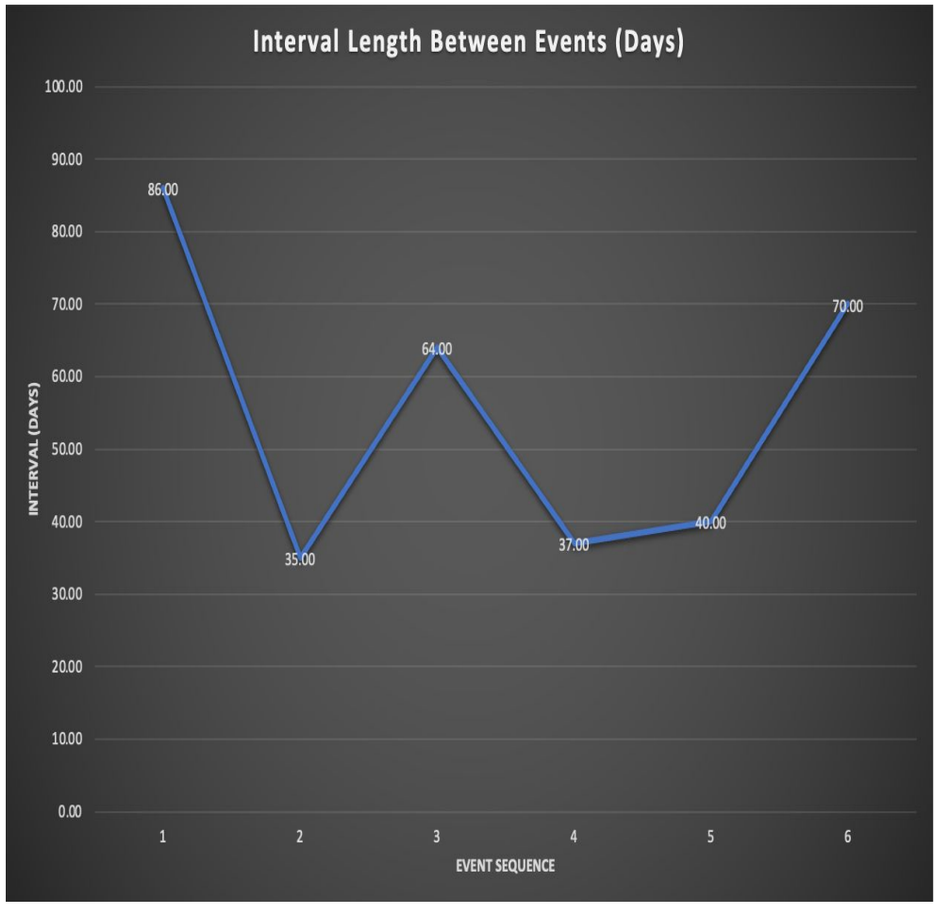
- Series Tempo
  - Series follows a generally stable rhythm
  - Mean interval: 55 days, SD 21 days → moderate variability
  - Intervals generally fall 34-76 days, the series operates at a relatively consistent tempo
- Series Sprees
  - No distinct sprees; events generally spaced evenly
  - Minor Clustering: 3 weekend events in a row
  - Event counts per cluster: 1-3 events
  - Duration of short clusters: 1-3 days between weekend events




EL PARTIDO DE AYER.—Del R. Madrid: Lopa Peña, Félix Pérez, Juan José Urquiza y Luis María Uriba. Del Bilbao: Martínez II, Pedro Cubo, Arana y Ricardo Castillo [Dibujos de Sancha.]

Temporal Analysis

- Peak Days & Times
  - Days of Week: Sundays (3 events), Saturday (2), Tuesday & Thursday (1 each)
  - Time of Day: majority midnight-3 a.m., 1 event at 7:30 p.m.
  - Weekday/Weekend: Weekend-dominant - 5 of 7 events
- Noteworthy Relationships
  - Interval vs. Victim Count: 0.43 → moderate positive correlation → events with more victims spaced slightly further apart
  - Late-night + Weekend preference

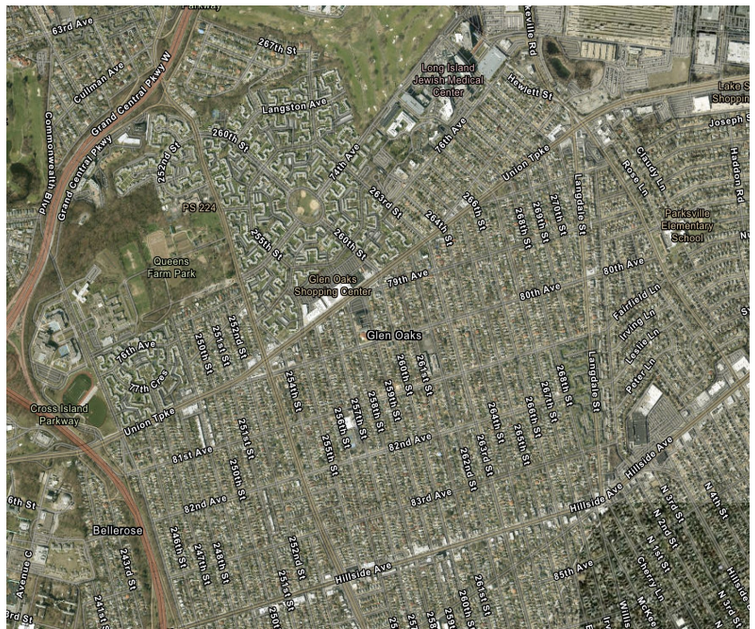


The next event is predicted between July 30 and September 10, 1977, most likely on a weekend (July 30–31; August 6–7, 13–14, 20–21, 27–28; September 3–4, 10–11). The highest risk is during nighttime hours, especially midnight–3 a.m., based on the series' intervals and predominance of weekend activity.

Intervention Strategy

A lone white offender attacks young females in parked vehicles at night across low-traffic streets and semi-private areas in New York, primarily on weekend nights. Following the last event, a targeted plan focuses on Clusters A and B. In Cluster A, officers will use unmarked vehicles and plainclothes patrols to intercept the offender, with two officers posing as a couple while others patrol nearby. Cluster B will have a weeklong nightly community meeting campaign, media alerts, fliers, and a tipline to raise awareness. Clusters C, D, and E are considered “dead” and will receive minimal patrols but continue to be monitored through intelligence and past case review. Across all active areas, marked patrols will deter attacks, task forces will coordinate across jurisdictions, and citywide media coverage will reinforce public awareness and safety during high-risk hours.







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Conclusion

- Serial killer targeting 13 victims since last year in New York City.
- Lone white male attacks young females in parked vehicles at night in low-traffic streets and semi-private areas across Queens and the Bronx, primarily on weekend nights, with events spaced roughly every 34-76 days.
- The offender follows predictable patterns in behavior, location, and timing, allowing targeted prevention. By focusing resources on Clusters A and B with interception, community awareness, and law enforcement patrols, attacks can be deterred and potential victims protected.